

STAGE FIVE • THINKING, REASONING & MENTAL MODELS

FIRSTS

COMPLETION CRITERIA

What counts as done, and how it triggers the Stage Five credential

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Completion Criteria & Credential Trigger

Stage Five • Thinking, Reasoning & Mental Models

PURPOSE

This document defines exactly what “complete” means for Stage Five, at both the individual FIRST level and the full-stage level, and how completion connects to the program's credentialing system. Because this stage's value depends heavily on genuine application rather than theoretical understanding, the completion standard specifically screens for real, concrete examples over abstract ones.

Per-FIRST Standard

STANDARD

A FIRST counts as complete when the corresponding Templates worksheet has a genuine, specific answer applying the framework to a real problem, not a hypothetical or generic example. A worksheet describing a mental model without ever applying it to a real, current situation does not meet the bar for this stage specifically, given how much of the value here depends on genuine application.

Stage-Level Completion Checklist

- All 30 Templates worksheets completed, each applying its framework to a real, specific problem or decision.
- Attendance or async completion confirmed for all 4 sessions.
- At least one FIRST from Session 3 (Advanced Frameworks I) shows evidence of a genuinely complex, multi-variable decision, not a simplified stand-in.
- One specific mental model or framework named explicitly at the stage close as something the participant intends to keep using.

Facilitator Sign-Off

The facilitator reviews each participant's completed Templates workbook, checking specifically for genuine application to real situations rather than abstract or textbook-style answers, before marking the stage complete in the program tracker. Given this stage's emphasis on application over theory, a technically complete worksheet built entirely on hypothetical examples should not be marked complete without a conversation encouraging a real, specific revision.

Credential Trigger

HOW THE BADGE WORKS

Upon facilitator sign-off, the participant's record is marked "Stage Five Complete" in the program tracker, which triggers the Stage Five digital badge. As with every stage, badges accumulate visibly; the full-program certificate is issued only once all 16 stages are marked complete.